

Critical Thinking (BES-103)

Lecture 2

Why Develop Critical Skills?

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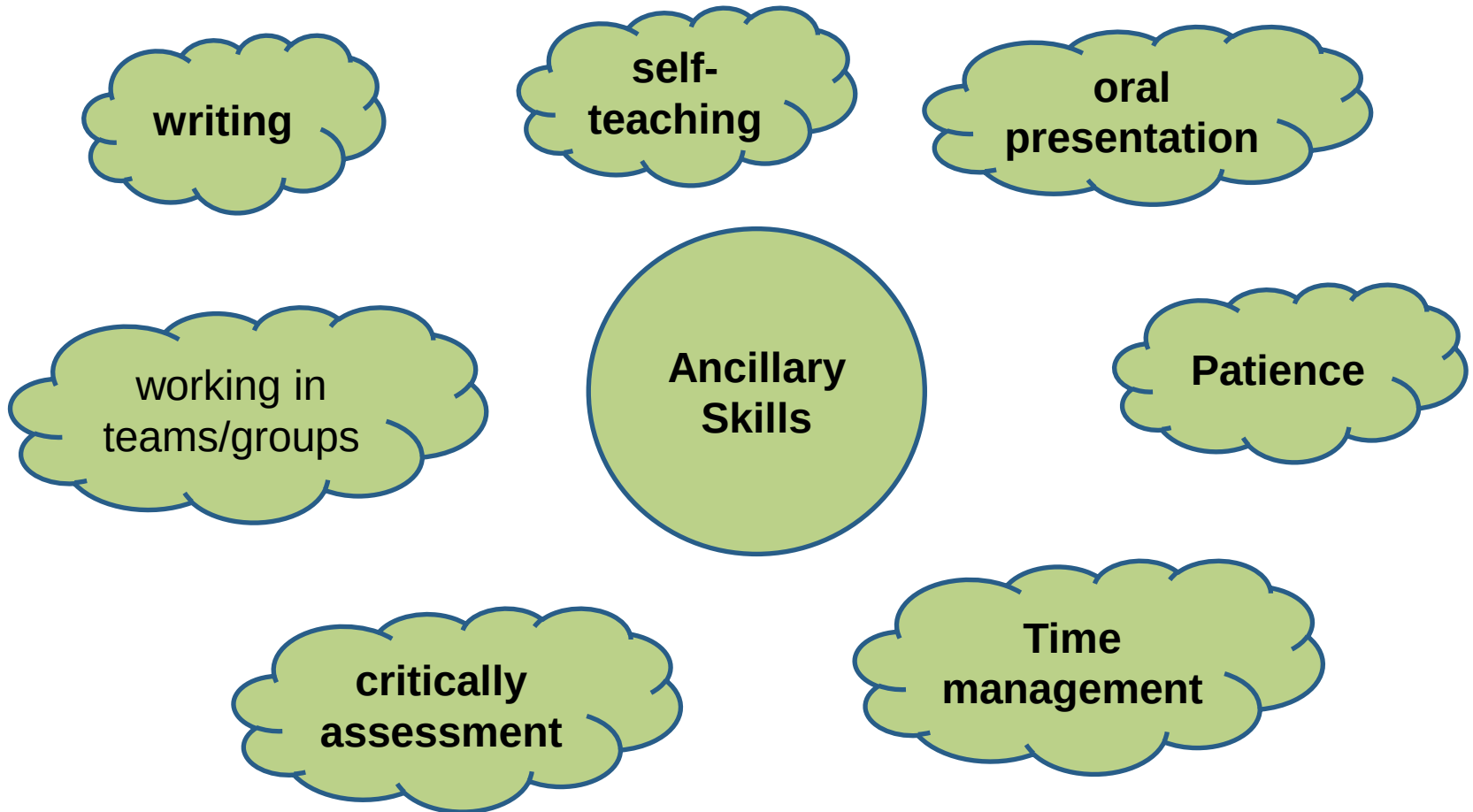
Lecture Outline

- ▷ Why Develop Critical thinking?
- ▷ Ancillary skills
- ▷ Underlying skills and development
- ▷ Self-awareness for accurate judgment.

Ancillary skills

Ancillary skills are skills that affect performance or address stressors that students commonly face but are not primarily academic or intellectual in nature.

Ancillary skills



What Soft Skills Do I Need for Computer Science?

Attention to detail: In the computer science and IT field, attention to detail is vital. You must be able to look at long lines of code and identify anything amiss. Having an eye for small details can help you have a huge impact on projects

Creativity: Creativity is key to solving problems and creating functional, modern web applications and websites.

Communication: In the IT world, communication is key. This soft skill is vital to help you talk to clients, coworkers, and managers. Show you're skilled when it comes to explaining your projects, objectives, and timelines.

Time management: Effective time management will help you stay on top of the various tasks and projects you'll face.

What Soft Skills Do I Need for Computer Science?

Teamwork & Cooperation: Being a good team player is key in any organization, but it's particularly important if you're working in computer science. Many times, software engineers, data scientists, and IT professionals are expected to collaborate with a number of different groups within an organization to ensure timelines are met and expectations are fulfilled.

Analysis: You must be able to analyze hundreds of lines of code to troubleshoot and find solutions. Above all, being proactive is key, as it's important to ensure quality at the creation stage to avoid costly fixes later.

Organization: Organizational skills are skills that allow you to use your resources efficiently and effectively.

Exercise

Analyze and write down what skills you have and the skills you wish to bring in yourself.

Underlying skills and development

When it comes to computer science and IT, there are a wide variety of programming languages that are vital to know.

- ▷ C#
- ▷ C++
- ▷ Python
- ▷ Asp.net
- ▷ PHP
- ▷ MERN Stack
- ▷ MEAN Stack etc....

Personal performance and learning SHAPES

- ▷ A reflecting tool to analyzing own performance
- ▷ SHAPES stands for **Skills, Habits, Attitudes, Preferences, Experience** and **Strategies**.
Understanding our own SHAPES for diverse activities can assist us in achieving our 'peak', or optimal, performance.

SHAPES

- ▷ **Skills:** Skills, here, refers to abilities and techniques that help you to perform effectively at study or work – such as
- ▷ Academic, People, Task, and Self-management skills.

SHAPES

Habit: A usual way of behaving: something that a person does often in a regular and repeated way.

Are you attached to any study habits or patterns of behavior that are not really helping your current study/work? If so, what needs to change?

SHAPES

Attitude:

an attitude refers to a set of emotions, beliefs, and behaviors toward a particular object, person, thing, or event.

SHAPES

Preference:

a greater liking for one alternative over another or others.

SHAPES

Experience: Our past experience shapes our readiness and confidence to take on new tasks, and the way we make sense of what is required.

SHAPES

Strategies:

a plan of action designed to achieve a long-term or overall aim.

Self-awareness for accurate judgment

“We must understand before we
pass judgment”

—H. I. Marrou

Self-awareness for accurate judgement

In groups of three or more, discuss which word from each of the pairs below you think is more accurate. Which word in the pair would you prefer to use? Which would you prefer to see used by writers and speakers? How would the context influence your judgment? The words in the right column might be considered euphemisms or politically correct terms.

Self-awareness for accurate judgment

retarded	mentally challenged
old, elderly	senior citizen
used car	pre-owned car
stewardess	flight attendant
fat	full-figured
deaf	hearing impaired
ghetto	culturally deprived area
divorced	newly single
primitive	preliterate
doorman	access controller
pimples	blemishes
pornography	adult entertainment
blockaded	quarantined
bombed	pacified
torture	enhanced interrogation techniques
freshman	first-year student
gambling	gaming

Reference

- ▷ <https://www.wgu.edu/blog/computer-science-skills-resume1911.html#close>
- ▷ [Encyclopedia of Tourism](#)
- ▷ Anand, Paul, 1993, “The Philosophy of Intransitive Preference”, *Economic Journal*, 103: 337–346.